4.5 Heart Failure*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I wake up at night unable to breathe." **Objective** • Crackles at both bases • Edema of both legs • Gained 3 kg in a week	**ACTUAL** Excessive fluid volume related to reduced cardiac pump function as evidenced by edema, crackles and weight gain.	• Weight and edema falling within 3 days.	• Weigh each morning before breakfast. • Keep a strict intake and output chart. • Restrict fluid and sodium as prescribed. • Give diuretics as ordered; follow potassium and creatinine. • Sit him upright.	• Considered met as weight and edema decrease.
Subjective • "I get tired walking to the bathroom." **Objective** • Breathless on minimal effort • HR rises by 30/min with activity	**ACTUAL** Decreased activity tolerance related to reduced cardiac output as evidenced by exertional fatigue and dyspnea.	• Manages self-care with acceptable breathlessness within 1 week.	• Plan rest between activities. • Increase activity a little at a time. • Check HR, BP and SpO_2 during activity.	• Goal reached when self-care is tolerated.
Subjective • "I do not weigh myself at home." **Objective** • Frequent readmissions	**RISK** Risk for impaired fluid volume balance as evidenced by risk factors: complex treatment regimen and absent self-monitoring.	• Knows when to call the physician, for example after a 2 kg gain in 3 days.	• Teach daily weighing and keeping a record. • Teach the low-sodium diet and the fluid limit. • Teach the signs that heart failure is worsening.	• Met when he describes his self-monitoring plan.

*References for this care plan: [17], [32], [33], [35].Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.